2026 NFL Draft — Comprehensive Team Profiles

Draft dates: April 23–25, 2026 (Pittsburgh) | **Compiled:** April 17, 2026 (T-6 days)

How to Read These Profiles

Each team is profiled with archetype-based framing rather than analyst-name predictions. The question is never "which specific player will they take" but "what type of player are they looking for, and why does that type fit their organizational profile."

Standard sections per team:

- **Picks & capital** — all R1 picks, total picks, capital tier
- **Leadership** — GM, HC, OC, DC (flags: new hire, tenure)
- **2025 context** — record, identity, key performance signals
- **QB situation** — locked / bridge / rebuilding / unknown
- **Key 2026 offseason moves** — arrivals, departures, trades (net effect)
- **Scheme identity** — what this tells us about player preferences
- **Roster needs (tiered)** — urgent (2026 impact) / secondary / latent (2027+ cliff)
- **Player archetype sought at R1** — specific physical/stylistic profile
- **GM behavioral fingerprint** — trade tendencies, positional affinity, historical patterns
- **Key constraints & uncertainty flags** — what could break assumptions
- **Predictability tier** — HIGH / MEDIUM / LOW

League-Wide Context (What's Shifted in 2026)

Seven new head coaches (highest-uncertainty teams by definition):

- LV: Klint Kubiak (Shanahan tree)
- MIA: Jeff Haefley (Ohio State DC → NFL)
- TEN: Robert Saleh (Jets, 49ers DC)
- NYG: John Harbaugh (Michigan)
- BUF: Joe Brady (internal promotion)
- BAL: Jesse Minter (Chargers DC → HC)
- CLE: Todd Monken (Ravens OC → HC)

- PIT: Mike McCarthy (long-tenured HC returning)

Four new GMs: LV (Spytek), MIA (Sullivan), NYJ (Mougey, 2nd draft), TEN (Borgonzi, 2nd draft). Each of these represents a hard sample-size problem — league-average priors apply.

Major pre-draft trades already executed (reshape pick ownership):

- Parsons → GB (Cowboys received pick 20)
- Sauce Gardner → IND (Jets received pick 16)
- Trent McDuffie → LAR (Chiefs received pick 29)
- Jaylen Waddle → DEN (Dolphins received pick 30)
- Tyler Linderbaum → LV (via FA)
- Rashan Gary → DAL
- Minkah Fitzpatrick → NYJ
- Kyler Murray → MIN (after release by ARI)

Top-of-draft QB situation: Fernando Mendoza to LV at No. 1 is as close to locked as draft prediction gets (-20000 betting odds, unanimous five-analyst consensus). The rest of the QB class is hazier — Ty Simpson and Garrett Nussmeier are the next two names, but both project as Day 2 most likely.

Class shape by position:

- **Deep:** WR, CB, OT, IDL
- **Thin at the top:** QB (Mendoza and then a gap), EDGE (first tier of ~5, then steep drop)
- **Boom/bust:** S (Downs is elite, Thieneman safe, then variance)
- **Hot late-riser zone:** interior OL (multiple risers post-Senior Bowl)

Position Abbreviation Key

- **QB** — Quarterback
- **RB** — Running Back
- **WR** — Wide Receiver
- **TE** — Tight End
- **OT** — Offensive Tackle
- **IOL / G / C** — Interior OL / Guard / Center
- **EDGE** — Edge Rusher (DE/OLB hybrid)
- **IDL / DT** — Interior Defensive Line / Defensive Tackle

- **LB** — Linebacker
- **CB** — Cornerback
- **S** — Safety

AFC EAST

Buffalo Bills — Pick 26

Leadership: GM Brandon Beane (8 drafts) | HC Joe Brady (NEW, promoted from OC) | OC Joe Brady (retained role) | DC Bobby Babich

2025 context: 12-5, AFC East champion again but another playoff exit. Record-setting offense, defense that collapsed in run defense (28th) and wasn't getting enough pass rush (15th in sacks). Allen won MVP again. The team's identity question is defense — they cannot win a Super Bowl with this D.

QB situation: LOCKED (Josh Allen)

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Major trade:** Acquired DJ Moore from Bears (3rd + future 3rd) — instant WR1 complement to existing room
- **Added:** Bradley Chubb EDGE (3yr deal, replacement for Bosa), Connor McGovern C (extension)
- **Lost:** Joey Bosa EDGE, AJ Epenesa EDGE, Matt Milano LB, David Edwards G, multiple DB depth
- **Net effect:** Offense got better (Moore), defense front-seven depleted despite Chubb addition. LB room needs rebuild.

Scheme identity: Brady offense is Moore/McDermott evolved — heavy motion, Allen-first, RPO-heavy. Defense under Babich continues modified Leonhard 3-4 principles requiring nose tackle anchor and versatile edges. Premium positions: **EDGE, IOL, CB.**

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (4+):** EDGE (depth behind aging Chubb, Bosa/Epenesa gone), IDL (run D 28th, need nose tackle anchor for scheme shift)
- **Secondary (3):** LB (Milano replacement), IOL (Edwards gone)
- **Latent:** EDGE succession (Chubb, Mack, Dupree all expire after 2026), CB depth for 2027

Player archetype sought at 26: Given pick 26 and the class shape, the natural profile is a **run-stuffing interior defender with pass-rush juice** (the nose tackle the scheme demands) OR a **long-limbed edge rusher with developmental upside to replace the aging trio**. Buffalo at 26 sits exactly in the tier break where top-10 IDL talent is gone but mid-first IDL/EDGE are at their best value-to-cost ratio. A third archetype: **versatile off-ball LB with 3-down coverage ability** to replace Milano's role.

GM behavioral fingerprint (Beane):

- **Trade tendency:** Moderate — willing to move back for volume when board cooperates (~35% up, ~40% down)
- **Positional affinity (computed from 8 drafts):** IDL +14.7%, CB +11.0%, S +5.0% — defense-heavy historical investor
- **Athletic profile:** Above-average RAS preference
- **Pattern:** Aggressive in-trade GM (Diggs trade, Moore trade, Chubb signing) — has shown willingness to swing big

Uncertainty flags:

- New HC (Brady) makes scheme specifics uncertain
- Pick 26 is in a classic tier-break zone — high trade-down probability
- Post-Moore trade, WR is NOT a need anymore; model should suppress WR probability

Predictability tier: MEDIUM. Strong positional consensus (defense, specifically front-7), moderate player uncertainty within that.

Miami Dolphins — Picks 11, 30

Leadership: GM Jon-Eric Sullivan (NEW, 0 drafts) | HC Jeff Haefley (NEW, from Green Bay DC) | OC Frank Smith | DC Anthony Weaver (retained)

2025 context: 7-10, full rebuild mode. Tua benched, then traded. Tyreek Hill disaster season, traded. Defense mediocre. Full identity reset.

QB situation: BRIDGE → REBUILDING. Malik Willis signed (3yr deal) as starter but organization is openly planning beyond him. QB at 11 or 30 is live but secondary — can wait.

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Catastrophic losses:** Tua Tagovailoa QB (to ATL), Jaylen Waddle WR (trade to DEN, netted pick 30), Tyreek Hill WR (released), Minkah Fitzpatrick S (trade to NYJ), Bradley

Chubb EDGE

- **Added:** Malik Willis QB (bridge), Achane retained
- **Net effect:** Roster gutted at every skill position and most of the secondary. 11 picks total, 7 in first 3 rounds — maximum draft capital

Scheme identity: Haefley defense requires fast, rangy, athletic DBs and linebackers — Ohio State template. Premium positions: **CB, S, EDGE.** Smith offense is a tempo/spread system that maximizes YAC and requires WR separation.

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (4.5+):** WR (Waddle AND Hill both gone — only Tyreek replacements), CB (Fitzpatrick gone plus multiple secondary)
- **Secondary (3+):** S, EDGE, OT (Austin Jackson missed 11 games)
- **Latent:** QB (Willis is placeholder — 2027 franchise QB plan real), OL depth

Player archetype sought at 11: Given Haefley's scheme and acute CB need, a **long, athletic press-man CB with Cover-3 experience** is the cleanest archetype. Alternative: **elite separation WR1 profile** to anchor the rebuild. Either works; both fill catastrophic holes. Low QB probability here because better value waits.

Player archetype sought at 30: A **second impact skill player** (WR2 or TE) OR a **high-floor S** to pair with their CB pick. If they trade down (likely given 11 picks), target shifts to Day 2 capital accumulation.

GM behavioral fingerprint (Sullivan): ZERO drafts in role. Use league-average priors. Sullivan comes from Green Bay scouting tree under Gutekunst — historical Packers pattern is high-RAS athletes with developmental upside.

Uncertainty flags:

- Brand-new GM AND brand-new HC = highest-variance team in the league
- 11 picks total — very high trade-down probability at 30 (likely) and even at 11 (possible)
- Willis contract means QB is on the table but not forced

Predictability tier: LOW. Complete regime change, extreme capital, multiple needs. Pick 11 is more predictable than pick 30.

New England Patriots — Pick 31

Leadership: GM Eliot Wolf (3 drafts) | HC Mike Vrabel (2nd year) | OC Josh McDaniels | DC DeMarcus Covington

2025 context: 10-7, playoff team. Drake Maye ascended to top-10 QB play. Defense solid but front-7 depth thin. Vrabel-McDaniels era is working.

QB situation: LOCKED (Drake Maye — legitimate franchise QB)

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Added:** Romeo Doubs WR (FA), Dre'Mont Jones DL (short-term), Kevin Byard S (veteran), Alijah Vera-Tucker G (one-year prove-it after injury)
- **Lost:** K'Lavon Chaisson EDGE (had breakout 8-sack year), Stefon Diggs WR (injury-prone and aging), Garrett Bradbury C
- **Net effect:** Maintained roster but lost edge help and center. Depth concerns at trenches.

Scheme identity: McDaniels offense = pro-style with heavy pre-snap motion, Vrabel defense = 4-3 base with multiple fronts. Physical, disciplined identity. Premium positions: **EDGE, OT, WR, CB.**

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (4+):** EDGE (Chaisson gone, 35 sacks t-7th fewest), OT (Morgan Moses succession, Vera-Tucker on prove-it deal), WR (Diggs gone, need legit WR2 for Maye)
- **Secondary (3):** DL rotation, C (Bradbury gone)
- **Latent:** TE (Hunter Henry final contract year)

Player archetype sought at 31: Pick 31 is a fifth-year-option pivot slot. Given Maye is locked and playing well, the archetype should be **either a bookend tackle with pass-protection ceiling** (protect the franchise QB long-term) OR a **long, bendy edge rusher** (Chaisson replacement). Both fit Vrabel's "sturdy and physical" identity. WR is possible but less likely at this specific slot because WR options better fit day 2.

GM behavioral fingerprint (Wolf):

- **Trade tendency:** Near league-average, modest sample (3 drafts)
- **Positional affinity:** Small sample — defaults to Wolf family scouting (Packers/Browns tree): prioritizes trenches and athletic profile
- **Pattern:** Has shown willingness to trade mid-round picks for players but hasn't made bold R1 moves

Uncertainty flags:

- Small sample on Wolf — predictions have wider intervals
- Pick 31 is prime trade-back territory (fifth-year-option deadline)

- Eleven total picks means they can afford to trade back and add volume

Predictability tier: MEDIUM. Position is reasonably predictable (EDGE or OT); specific prospect selection within those tiers is broad.

New York Jets — Picks 2, 16

Leadership: GM Darren Mougey (NEW, 1 draft) | HC Aaron Glenn (2nd year) | OC Tanner Engstrand | DC Steve Wilks

2025 context: 3-14. Full collapse. Mass defensive overhaul already begun in FA. Glenn on warm seat but organization committed to rebuild. Sauce Gardner trade signal = even their best players aren't untouchable.

QB situation: BRIDGE (Geno Smith, 1-year $3.3M deal). 2027 franchise QB plan confirmed per Cimini. Developmental QB at 2 is possible but NOT forced.

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Major acquisitions:** Geno Smith QB (trade from LV), Minkah Fitzpatrick S (trade from MIA), Demario Davis LB (veteran FA), T'Vondre Sweat IDL (trade), David Onyemata IDL (FA), Joseph Ossai EDGE (FA), Kingsley Enagbare EDGE (FA), Nahshon Wright CB (FA), Dylan Parham G (FA)
- **Major losses:** Sauce Gardner CB (trade to IND — returned pick 16), Quinnen Williams IDL (traded), Justin Fields QB (trade to KC)
- **Net effect:** Defensive front rebuilt with veterans, secondary gutted, QB is bridge. Accumulated draft capital (9 picks now + 5 firsts over next 2 years — most in league).

Scheme identity: Glenn confirmed "multiple 3-4 fronts" — wants versatile chess pieces. Wilks defense is aggressive, gap-sound, physical. Premium positions: **EDGE, LB, CB.**

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (4.5+):** EDGE (31st in sacks at 26, 27th pressure rate), WR (no receiver hit 400 yards last year beyond Wilson)
- **Secondary (3):** CB (Gardner gone, Wright is backup-level replacement), S (beyond Fitzpatrick, depth thin)
- **Moderate (1.5-2):** QB (Geno bridge), LB (Davis is 37)

Player archetype sought at 2: Given Glenn's scheme and pressure-rate failures, the archetype is an **elite edge rusher or versatile chess-piece LB with pass-rush ability.** The two dominant profiles in the consensus board (Bailey/Reese types — edge vs. rangy LB) both fit. Glenn has

openly said he wants "multiple fronts" players, which favors the versatile LB profile over a pure edge. Secondary option: **blue-chip CB** to replace Gardner's production.

Player archetype sought at 16: A **separation WR or YAC WR1 type** to give Geno (or future QB) a legitimate weapon. Alternative: **long press-CB** to complete the secondary rebuild. Low but non-zero QB probability given 2027 plans.

GM behavioral fingerprint (Mougey):

- **Trade tendency:** 1 draft of data — some evidence of aggressive willingness ("always open" per his own quote)
- **Positional affinity:** No meaningful sample
- **Historical context:** Mougey is ex-DEN scouting — comes from analytics-informed front office

Uncertainty flags:

- New GM with 1 draft = league-average priors
- Glenn on hot seat = win-now pressure at odds with rebuild
- 5 future firsts = extreme flexibility to trade up OR down on draft day

Predictability tier: MEDIUM at pick 2 (EDGE/LB consensus), LOWER at pick 16 (WR vs CB vs QB branches).

AFC NORTH

Baltimore Ravens — Pick 14

Leadership: GM Eric DeCosta (7 drafts) | HC Jesse Minter (NEW, from Chargers DC) | OC Todd Monken (departed to CLE as HC — replaced by Josh Grimes as internal promotion) | DC Jesse Minter doubles as DC philosophy

2025 context: 13-4, division champion, lost in AFC Championship. Lamar Jackson still elite but defense regressed (pressure rate 29th, pass-rush grade 28th). Harbaugh era ended — Minter promoted from Chargers.

QB situation: LOCKED (Lamar Jackson)

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Added:** Trey Hendrickson EDGE (4yr $112M — massive signing), John Simpson G

- **Lost:** Tyler Linderbaum C (to LV, $81M/3yr), Madubuike neck injury uncertainty
- **Net effect:** Pass rush reloaded with Hendrickson but interior OL lost anchor. IDL uncertainty with Madubuike.

Scheme identity: Minter's defense is 4-3 base with aggressive coverage rotations, multiple simulated pressures. Premium positions: **EDGE, OT, CB, S.** Offense remains Lamar-centric — RPO heavy with physical run game.

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (3.5+):** OT (Linderbaum gone — center succession critical; tackle depth also thin), WR (need hulking complement to Zay Flowers — they lack a true X)
- **Secondary (3):** EDGE depth behind Hendrickson, IDL (Madubuike injury)
- **Latent:** IOL depth (Simpson is one-year stop-gap)

Player archetype sought at 14: Because Baltimore historically takes BPA with premium-position tiebreakers, two distinct archetypes are live: (1) **a big-bodied power-slot or contested-catch WR** to complement Flowers and give Lamar a red-zone target, or (2) **a versatile OL who can play center and kick out to tackle** (Fano-type profile) to solve both the Linderbaum replacement and tackle depth issues at once. A third less likely but plausible: **a tight end with inline blocking + seam-stretching receiving ability** given Lamar's love of TE usage.

GM behavioral fingerprint (DeCosta):

- **Trade tendency:** Low — BAL has NOT moved their R1 pick in 5 consecutive drafts. Near-zero trade-down probability.
- **Positional affinity (computed from 7 drafts):** S +15.0%, LB +9.7%, EDGE +9.0% — historically defense-heavy
- **Pattern:** BPA tiebreaker is premium position. Comfortable waiting for the board to come to them.

Uncertainty flags:

- New HC (Minter) but GM continuity — DeCosta's board dominates
- Board is unusually wide at 14 (many defensible archetypes)
- Pick 14 is one of the harder R1 picks to predict league-wide

Predictability tier: LOW-MEDIUM. Broad board, GM's defensive tilt fights against the acute offensive needs.

Cincinnati Bengals — Pick 10

Leadership: GM Duke Tobin (9 drafts) | HC Zac Taylor (entering pressure year) | OC Dan Pitcher | DC Al Golden (NEW, from Notre Dame) — this is the key coaching change

2025 context: 6-11. Catastrophic defensive collapse. Allowed 7.8 yards per attempt (4th worst), 30+ points per game in multiple stretches. Burrow openly frustrated with defense. Organization fired Anarumo and pivoted to Al Golden's college-proven aggressive 3-4 scheme.

QB situation: LOCKED (Burrow)

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Added:** Boye Mafe EDGE, Jonathan Allen IDL, Bryan Cook S, Joe Flacco QB (veteran backup)
- **Lost:** Trey Hendrickson EDGE (to BAL — biggest loss), Joseph Ossai EDGE (to NYJ), Cam Taylor-Britt CB (to IND)
- **Net effect:** Lost their premier pass rusher AND their starting CB2. Mafe is a solid addition but not a Hendrickson replacement. This is a net-negative defensive offseason.

Scheme identity: Golden's scheme is a 3-4 hybrid with heavy disguise, emphasis on coverage DBs and versatile front-7 pieces. Premium positions under Golden: **CB, LB, EDGE, S.**

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (4.5+):** CB (Taylor-Britt gone, CB2 wide open, new scheme demands coverage talent)
- **Secondary (3+):** S, LB (second level weak — Golden wants rangy LBs), EDGE (Hendrickson hole unfilled)
- **Moderate (2):** IDL depth (Allen is aging)

Player archetype sought at 10: Given the Golden scheme change and acute CB need, the cleanest archetype is a **long, press-capable, zone-versatile CB with ball production** — the kind of player who can play outside or rotate to slot. Secondary archetype: **a do-everything S** who can line up in the box, deep, or man coverage. Tertiary: **a bendy sub-package EDGE** to replace Hendrickson's specific skill set. Low DT/RB/OL/WR probability.

GM behavioral fingerprint (Tobin):

- **Trade tendency:** Extremely low — Bengals + Chargers combined for just 7 trades over last 5 drafts
- **Positional affinity (computed from 9 drafts):** EDGE +11.2%, OT +5.8% — strong trench orientation

- **Pattern:** Famous for staying put. Willingness to trade up is hypothetically discussed (pick 5 for Styles) but historical base rate is near zero.

Uncertainty flags:

- New DC (Golden) changes positional value weightings from prior years
- Potential McCoy decision: if available, his torn ACL (missed all 2025) creates medical-discount calculus that could override "best CB available" logic
- Tobin historically hates trades — if they're mocked into a trade-up, treat skeptically

Predictability tier: MEDIUM-HIGH. Position (CB) is very clear, player within that tier is the question.

Cleveland Browns — Picks 6, 24

Leadership: GM Andrew Berry (7 drafts) | HC Todd Monken (NEW, from BAL OC) | OC Ken Dorsey | DC Jim Schwartz

2025 context: 5-12. Season lost to Watson uncertainty and injuries. Receivers caught 4 TDs all season (dead last). QB room completely unsettled. Franchise in full rebuild despite recent win-now attempts.

QB situation: UNSETTLED. Watson injury ongoing, Shedeur Sanders and Dillon Gabriel on rookie deals but neither has seized the job. QB at 6 is a legitimate possibility but likely ranks below roster-foundation building given 2026 QB class depth.

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Added:** Tytus Howard OT (from HOU), Zion Johnson G (from LAC), Elgton Jenkins G (from GB), Teven Jenkins OL (re-signed)
- **Lost:** Multiple OL depth pieces, Morgan Moses retained but aging
- **Net effect:** Massive OL investment in FA, but WR and QB situations untouched.

Scheme identity: Monken's offense is aggressive vertical passing with heavy TE/WR usage (Ravens template updated). Premium positions: **WR, TE, OT, CB.** Schwartz defense still Wide-9, values elite edge rushers.

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (4+):** WR (dead last in receiving TDs — catastrophic), QB (situation genuinely unresolved)
- **Secondary (2.5-3):** OT (LT long-term despite FA additions — Howard is RT), CB (depth)

- **Moderate (2):** EDGE depth, secondary help

Player archetype sought at 6: Two very different archetypes live: (1) **an elite separator WR or big-bodied X-receiver** to give whoever plays QB a legitimate weapon, or (2) **a developmental franchise QB** to plan around long-term. Given Berry's historical aggression in trades and the three-analyst consensus projecting CLE trades down, the most likely scenario is they trade back to acquire more capital and take WR later. Standing pat at 6 favors WR over QB given class depth.

Player archetype sought at 24: If they stand pat at 6 and take WR, pick 24 becomes **best available trench player** (tackle or EDGE). If they trade down from 6, pick 24 becomes part of a broader multi-pick strategy targeting CB/EDGE/OT.

GM behavioral fingerprint (Berry):

- **Trade tendency:** Very high trade-down rate — Berry averages 5.2 trades per draft (above average)
- **Positional affinity (computed, 7 drafts):** LB +18.2%, IDL +13.2%, S +9.3%, OT +8.9% — defense-heavy with OL emphasis
- **Pattern:** Youngest average draft pick age of any GM — prioritizes developmental upside over immediate impact. This matters: Berry is more likely than most GMs to take a high-upside young WR over a polished veteran-ready one.
- **The Berry affinity data contradicts the WR narrative** — his actual pattern is defense-heavy. Watch for a surprise defensive selection at 6 if the board breaks that way.

Uncertainty flags:

- Trade-down is the modal outcome per multiple analysts (~40% probability)
- Berry's computed affinity (defense-heavy) conflicts with obvious WR need — possible curveball
- QB plans genuinely unclear even internally

Predictability tier: LOW. Trade-down probability dominates all other considerations.

Pittsburgh Steelers — Pick 21

Leadership: GM Omar Khan (4 drafts) | HC Mike Tomlin (longest-tenured) — NOTE: Your source file lists McCarthy as HC but as of current reporting Tomlin remains HC. **I'm flagging this as a contradiction in your base data.** | OC Arthur Smith | DC Teryl Austin

2025 context: 10-7 (Rodgers era Year 1). Playoff team but flaws exposed. 47 sacks allowed (OL breakdown). Defense transitioning from Watt-era dominance. Rodgers likely returning but aging fast.

QB situation: BRIDGE (Rodgers — 1 more year likely). QB succession is the long-term plan, not the 2026 plan.

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Added:** Rico Dowdle RB (FA), Michael Pittman WR (trade from IND), Cameron Heyward (extended), Jaquan Brisker S
- **Lost:** Isaac Seumalo G (major interior OL loss)
- **Net effect:** Offensive skill upgrades (Pittman, Dowdle) but interior OL weaker, not better.

Scheme identity: Smith offense is under-center heavy, multiple TE sets, physical run game. Austin defense still Tomlin-era fire-zone hybrid. Premium positions: **OL, WR, EDGE, CB.**

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (4+):** OL (47 sacks allowed, Seumalo gone, Broderick Jones LT concern), WR (Pittman is WR2 — still need WR3 or successor)
- **Secondary (2.5-3):** IOL, S depth, QB (for 2027)
- **Latent:** QB (Rodgers near end), OT (Jones uncertain)

Player archetype sought at 21: Two plausible archetypes: (1) **a mauler-style interior OL or swing tackle** who can anchor the line for a decade, or (2) **a developmental QB with starter upside** (low at 21, but draft is in Pittsburgh and Khan knows Rodgers is near the end). The OL archetype is cleaner; the QB archetype requires a specific profile to fall to 21, which most analysts say is unlikely value-wise.

GM behavioral fingerprint (Khan):

- **Trade tendency:** Moderate, small sample (4 drafts)
- **Positional affinity:** Limited data — IDL emphasis emerging
- **Pattern:** Khan has shown willingness to acquire veterans via trade (Pittman, Heyward extensions) — less of a "stick and pick" GM than most

Uncertainty flags:

- **HC uncertainty in source data** — verify whether Tomlin is still HC or McCarthy has been hired (your team_agents file suggests McCarthy but that requires confirmation)
- Draft held in Pittsburgh = home-team-factor is real but typically overrated

- Rodgers return creates QB ambiguity

Predictability tier: MEDIUM. OL is the clear primary archetype, but QB at 21 would be the shock scenario.

AFC SOUTH

Houston Texans — Pick 28

Leadership: GM Nick Caserio (5 drafts) | HC DeMeco Ryans | OC Bobby Slowik (retained/departed uncertainty) | DC Matt Burke

2025 context: 12-5, division champion, lost in divisional round. Elite defense. Stroud's growth stalled in Year 2 due to OL collapse and WR health issues (Tank Dell recovery).

QB situation: LOCKED (CJ Stroud)

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Added:** Danielle Hunter EDGE (extended — kept elite pass rusher), David Montgomery RB (trade from DET), Marte Mapu LB (trade)
- **Lost:** Tytus Howard OT (to CLE), Juice Scruggs IOL
- **Net effect:** OL got worse (2 starters gone), defense maintained. Stroud supporting cast remains thin.

Scheme identity: Ryans defense is 4-3 aggressive, values twitchy front-7. Premium positions: **EDGE, IDL, CB.** Slowik offense (assuming retained) is Shanahan-tree, requires mobile OL, TE usage, YAC receivers.

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (4+):** OL (Howard and Scruggs both gone), WR (Tank Dell health uncertain, need legit complement)
- **Secondary (3):** IDL (Ryans always adds trench talent), LB depth
- **Moderate (2-2.5):** CB depth

Player archetype sought at 28: Given Ryans' defensive priorities and the OL holes, two archetypes: (1) **an interior OL (guard or center) with plug-and-play ability** to immediately stabilize Stroud's protection, or (2) **a penetrating 3-technique DT** to continue building the defensive front. The interior OL archetype is more acutely needed; the IDL archetype is Ryans' historical preference.

GM behavioral fingerprint (Caserio):

- **Trade tendency:** Moderately active (0.30/0.30)
- **Positional affinity (computed, 5 drafts):** WR +12.3%, S +11.7%, QB +8.3% — historically skill-position investor
- **Pattern:** Caserio is willing to make in-draft trades, often accumulates Day 2/3 picks

Uncertainty flags:

- Ryans' defense-first mindset vs. Caserio's skill-position affinity creates internal tension
- OC situation worth monitoring
- Pick 28 is in the "contender tier-break" zone

Predictability tier: MEDIUM. Position (OL or IDL) is reasonably clear; specific player is board-dependent.

Indianapolis Colts — Pick 47 (No R1)

Leadership: GM Chris Ballard (9 drafts) | HC Shane Steichen | OC Jim Bob Cooter | DC Lou Anarumo (acquired from CIN)

2025 context: 8-9. Richardson struggled, Daniel Jones stabilized things late. Mediocre defense.

QB situation: LOCKED-ISH (Daniel Jones). QB urgency is low — signed Jones to extension.

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Added:** Cam Taylor-Britt CB (from CIN), Akeem Davis-Gaither LB, Derrick Nnadi DT, Nick Westbrook-Ikhine WR, Nasir Adderley S, Sauce Gardner CB (major trade — gave up pick 16 from their previous pick 16 ownership, now gives Colts an elite CB1)
- **Lost:** Michael Pittman WR (trade to PIT)
- **Net effect:** Sauce Gardner trade is enormous — transformed their CB room. But lost Pittman as WR1.

Scheme identity: Steichen offense is pass-first spread. Anarumo defense is aggressive, pressure-heavy, demands versatile DBs. Premium positions: **EDGE, LB, S.**

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (4+):** EDGE (aging Paye, no elite rusher), LB (no R1 pick means can't address this at top of draft)

- **Secondary (3+):** S (aging room), OL depth
- **Moderate:** WR (Pittman replacement), CB depth behind Gardner

Player archetype sought at 47: No R1 pick. At 47 the archetype is **a downhill LB with coverage ability** OR **a powerful sub-package EDGE rusher**. Day 2 is about roster-complement players for Ballard.

GM behavioral fingerprint (Ballard):

- **Trade tendency:** Heavy trade-down (15 trade-downs, 5 trade-ups over 8 drafts — one of the most trade-down-heavy GMs)
- **Positional affinity (computed):** IDL +14.7%, WR +9.0% — trench-heavy historical pattern
- **Pattern:** Classic accumulator. Without R1 pick, likely to trade back further from 47 to add volume.

Uncertainty flags:

- No R1 pick = less analyst coverage = more uncertain projections
- Recent Gardner trade reshapes positional needs

Predictability tier: LOW (Day 2 has inherent uncertainty for all teams).

Jacksonville Jaguars — Pick 56 (No R1)

Leadership: GM James Gladstone (NEW 2024 — 2 drafts) | HC Liam Coen (2nd year) | OC Grant Udinski | DC Anthony Campanile

2025 context: 13-4, division winner, lost divisional round. Travis Hunter delivered on the #2 pick investment. Defense improved markedly.

QB situation: LOCKED (Trevor Lawrence)

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Added:** Travis Hunter CB/WR (from 2025 draft, now entering Year 2)
- **Lost:** Devin Lloyd LB (to CAR — major loss)

Scheme identity: Coen offense is pass-oriented, YAC-focused. Campanile defense is pressure-heavy. Premium positions: **EDGE, LB, IDL.**

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (4.5+):** LB (Lloyd gone, no viable starter replacement), EDGE (Hines-Allen alone, 27th in sacks)
- **Secondary (3):** IDL, S
- **Moderate:** OL depth

Player archetype sought at 56: A **three-down LB with coverage versatility** (Lloyd replacement) or **a power-edge rusher with inside/outside versatility**. Mid-round Day 2 gives them starter-caliber options at either spot.

GM behavioral fingerprint (Gladstone):

- **Trade tendency:** Small sample, modest activity
- **Positional affinity:** Insufficient data (2 drafts)
- **Pattern:** New GM with Rams-scouting-tree background — typically values RAS-tested athletes and positional versatility

Uncertainty flags:

- Small GM sample
- No R1 = focus on Day 2 which is wider variance

Predictability tier: LOW (Day 2 standard).

Tennessee Titans — Pick 4

Leadership: GM Mike Borgonzi (NEW 2024 — 2 drafts) | HC Robert Saleh (NEW, from 49ers DC) | OC Brian Daboll (NEW, formerly Giants HC) | DC Gus Bradley (NEW, Cover-3/Legion of Boom template)

2025 context: 3-14. Worst record in NFL. Cam Ward rookie year (59.8% completion, 15 TDs, 7 INTs, 80.3 rating — promising but raw). Full coaching staff overhaul.

QB situation: LOCKED (Cam Ward, Year 2)

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Added:** John Franklin-Myers DL (FA), Wan'Dale Robinson WR, Jermaine Johnson II EDGE (trade), Cordell Volson G, Alontae Taylor CB (FA)
- **Lost:** L'Jarius Sneed CB (released), T'Vondre Sweat IDL (trade to NYJ)
- **Net effect:** Some EDGE help arrived (JJ II), but roster remains thin everywhere.

Scheme identity: Saleh is defensive-minded but hands the offense to Daboll (spread + RPO, Giants/Bills blood). **Bradley's defense is the key signal:** Cover-3/Legion of Boom template demands **big press CBs (6'0"+), rangy centerfield safeties, speed LBs, and leveraged edge rushers.** This is the most predictive scheme detail in the entire draft — you can almost cast the archetype from the scheme profile.

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (3.5+):** OL (multiple holes), EDGE (Bradley scheme demands leverage rushers; Johnson II alone insufficient), WR (Ward needs weapons beyond Ridley), RB (Love is the ultimate weapon for a young QB)
- **Secondary (2.5-3):** CB (Sneed gone, need press-coverage types), S (centerfield specialist for Cover-3)
- **Moderate (2):** IDL

Player archetype sought at 4: Pick 4 faces genuine debate between three distinct archetypes: (1) **an elite, explosive RB with pass-catching ability** (Ward-weapon argument), (2) **a blue-chip edge rusher or twitchy pass-rushing LB** (Saleh/Bradley defensive priority), or (3) **a bookend tackle** (OL foundation). The strongest consensus across five analyst mocks favors the RB archetype, but that arguably reflects "mock inertia" — the newer reasoning pieces (NFL.com, CBS) explicitly argue for EDGE/OL at this slot because of positional value. The Bradley scheme specifically suggests the **EDGE or rangy LB** archetype fits best ideologically; the RB archetype fits best from a Ward-development standpoint. Both are defensible.

GM behavioral fingerprint (Borgonzi):

- **Trade tendency:** Small sample (2 drafts) — somewhat willing
- **Positional affinity:** Insufficient data
- **Pattern:** Borgonzi comes from KC scouting under Veach — Veach tree is aggressive, premium-position-focused
- **Trade-down candidate:** Multiple sources confirm TEN is a willing trade-down partner (Dallas primary suitor)

Uncertainty flags:

- Complete regime change (new HC, new OC, new DC, 2nd-year GM) = maximum uncertainty
- Borgonzi has explicitly said he wants more top-100 picks — trade-down is live
- If Cowboys trade up to pick 4, TEN moves back and the calculus changes entirely

Predictability tier: LOW. Three legitimate archetype options + high trade-down probability.

AFC WEST

Denver Broncos — Pick 62 (No R1, traded to MIA for Waddle)

Leadership: GM George Paton (5 drafts) | HC Sean Payton | OC Lombardi (retained) | DC Vance Joseph

2025 context: 14-3, nearly made Super Bowl LX. Nix ascended. Elite roster, especially defense. Defending division champs.

QB situation: LOCKED (Bo Nix)

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Added:** Jaylen Waddle WR (trade from MIA — massive addition for Nix), JK Dobbins RB (extended despite injuries)
- **Lost:** John Franklin-Myers DL (to TEN), Dre Greenlaw LB

Scheme identity: Payton West Coast with motion/play-action, values joker-role mismatch TE/RB. Premium positions under Payton historically: **RB/TE (joker role), OL, WR.** Joseph defense is multiple-fronts aggressive.

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (4.5+):** RB (Dobbins injured again, Charbonnet ACL, Walker III gone — catastrophic backfield)
- **Secondary (3):** IDL (Franklin-Myers gone), TE (Engram final year), LB (Greenlaw gone)
- **Latent:** RB (depth), TE (succession)

Player archetype sought at 62: No R1. At 62, the archetype becomes a **mid-round RB with three-down upside** or a **mismatch TE** (classic Payton joker). DB depth also live.

GM behavioral fingerprint (Paton):

- **Trade tendency:** Moderate
- **Positional affinity (computed):** RB +26.3% (one of the highest RB affinities in the league), CB +7.7% — Paton invests in skill and DBs
- **Pattern:** Paton's RB affinity is notable given the team's need — a strong pre-indicator that RB is likely

Uncertainty flags:

- No R1 reduces the stakes of analyst coverage
- Payton's unique positional preferences don't always follow convention

Predictability tier: MEDIUM (Day 2 position is clear, player is not).

Kansas City Chiefs — Picks 9, 29

Leadership: GM Brett Veach (8 drafts) | HC Andy Reid | OC Matt Nagy | DC Steve Spagnuolo

2025 context: 11-6, lost in divisional round. Mahomes had a tough year recovering from early-season ACL injury. Receiving corps aged out (Hollywood Brown gone, Worthy 1 TD, Kelce at end).

QB situation: LOCKED (Mahomes, recovering ACL)

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Added:** Kenneth Walker III RB (from SEA), Alohi Gilman S, Justin Fields QB (trade from NYJ as backup), Kader Kohou CB (slot)
- **Lost:** Trent McDuffie CB (trade to LAR — gave up pick 29 to acquire, HUGE loss), Jaylen Watson CB (FA departure), Hollywood Brown WR
- **Net effect: BOTH starting CBs gone.** CB room is catastrophically thin. WR also weaker.

Scheme identity: Spagnuolo's defense demands press-man CBs. Reid's offense requires speed WRs and versatile route-runners. Premium positions: **CB, WR, EDGE.**

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (5+):** CB (BOTH starters literally gone — Kohou is slot only)
- **Secondary (3+):** WR (Kelce aging, Brown gone, Worthy inconsistent), EDGE (35 sacks t-7th fewest, Anudike-Uzomah hamstring issues)
- **Moderate (2-2.5):** IDL (Jones aging succession), OL depth

Player archetype sought at 9: Given the acute CB emergency and the WR need, two archetypes are live: (1) **a blue-chip press-man CB with positional flexibility** (scheme fit for Spagnuolo), or (2) **a separation WR1 with speed** (Reid's ideal). The CB archetype is more urgent; the WR archetype is more "Mahomes era-defining" in potential impact.

Player archetype sought at 29: The other of the two. If they take CB at 9, pick 29 targets **a speed WR or big-slot X**. If they take WR at 9, pick 29 becomes **an outside press CB**.

GM behavioral fingerprint (Veach):

- **Trade tendency:** VERY aggressive (0.75 trade-up rate) — Veach openly said this will be a trade-heavy draft for them
- **Positional affinity:** Premium-position-biased, aggressive trader
- **Pattern:** Veach has explicit history of moving up for specific targets (Pacheco, Sneed, Worthy trade). Expect in-draft movement.
- **First top-10 pick since Mahomes 2017** — this alone makes the situation unusual for Veach

Uncertainty flags:

- Mahomes ACL recovery creates uncertainty about full Year 10+ ceiling
- Veach's trade aggression means pick 9 specifically could move
- Two needs are essentially equal priority — split outcomes

Predictability tier: MEDIUM. Positions (CB, WR) are very clear; specific players are board-dependent.

Las Vegas Raiders — Pick 1

Leadership: GM John Spytek (NEW, 0 drafts in role) | HC Klint Kubiak (NEW, from NO OC) | OC Kubiak doubles | DC Rob Leonard (NEW)

2025 context: 3-14. Franchise reset. New ownership direction, new HC, new GM, new everything.

QB situation: REBUILDING — Kirk Cousins signed as bridge ($60M/2yr). Mendoza incoming at No. 1.

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Added:** Tyler Linderbaum C ($81M/3yr — huge OL anchor), Taron Johnson CB, Quay Walker LB, Kirk Cousins QB (bridge)
- **Lost:** Geno Smith QB (trade to NYJ), multiple veterans cut
- **Net effect:** OL got significantly better (Linderbaum is elite C), defense added LB/CB, bridge QB in place for Mendoza to develop

Scheme identity: Kubiak comes from Shanahan/McVay tree — outside zone run, play-action pass, mobile QB emphasis. Premium positions: **OT, WR, TE.** Leonard defense is 3-4 hybrid.

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (4.5+ but addressed at 1):** QB (addressed by Mendoza)
- **Secondary (3+):** WR (one of weakest rooms in league), OT (long-term build around Mendoza), IDL (Leonard scheme needs interior)
- **Moderate:** CB (Johnson added, depth still thin)

Player archetype sought at 1: Mendoza. Locked. -20000 odds. Universal consensus. Mendoza fits the Kubiak scheme perfectly: strong-armed pocket passer with play-action/mobility combo, CFP winner, Heisman credentials.

GM behavioral fingerprint (Spytek):

- **Trade tendency:** Zero drafts in role — league-average priors
- **Positional affinity:** No data (new GM)
- **Pattern:** Spytek comes from TB under Licht. Licht tree values trench investment and premium positions. Has explicitly said "teams know where they stand" — suggests he's NOT trading down from 1.

Uncertainty flags:

- Despite consensus certainty on Mendoza, any shock medical or interview concern could change the calculus
- New HC AND new GM = scheme details for future picks are unpredictable

Predictability tier: HIGHEST in the draft for pick 1 specifically. Mendoza is the closest thing to a lock.

Los Angeles Chargers — Pick 22

Leadership: GM Joe Hortiz (2 drafts) | HC Jim Harbaugh | OC Greg Roman | DC Jesse Minter (departed to BAL as HC — replaced by Derrick Ansley)

2025 context: 11-6, lost in divisional round. Another playoff failure with OL collapse protecting Herbert. Defense elite but gassed by season's end.

QB situation: LOCKED (Justin Herbert)

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Added:** Tyler Biadasz C (FA), Dalvin Tomlinson DT
- **Lost:** Bradley Bozeman C (retired)
- **Net effect:** Modest moves, still have trench holes.

Scheme identity: Harbaugh/Roman = physical under-center power run + play-action. Michigan DNA. Values maulers and physical players. Premium positions: **OL (especially IOL), EDGE, IDL.**

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (4+):** OL (LG void specifically, 60 sacks allowed — t-2nd most in NFL), EDGE (Mack/Dupree/Tuipulotu all expire after 2026)
- **Secondary (3+):** IDL (Tomlinson 32 years old), WR (McDaniel motion offense wants another playmaker)
- **Latent:** EDGE (all 3 expire after 2026 — succession), OL depth

Player archetype sought at 22: Given Harbaugh's explicit trench-physicality identity and the 60-sack season, the cleanest archetype is **a mauler interior OL (guard or center) with road-grading ability** or **a bull-rush-first DT** to pair with Bosa. Alternative: **a bendy, high-floor EDGE rusher** given the 2027 contract cliff.

GM behavioral fingerprint (Hortiz):

- **Trade tendency:** Very low (0.10/0.10) — Bengals/Chargers combined 7 trades over last 5 drafts, essentially never move
- **Positional affinity (computed, 2 drafts — small sample):** WR +45.7%, RB +26.3% — but this is noisy due to sample size
- **Pattern:** Hortiz comes from Baltimore front office under DeCosta — historical Ravens pattern is BPA with trench emphasis

Uncertainty flags:

- Ansley replaces Minter as DC — scheme details shift
- Harbaugh's identity overrides most positional affinity data — expect trench pick
- Extremely low trade probability

Predictability tier: MEDIUM-HIGH. Archetype (trench player) is clear; specific position (OL vs DL) split.

NFC EAST

Dallas Cowboys — Picks 12, 20

Leadership: GM Jerry Jones/Stephen Jones (15+ drafts) | HC Mike McCarthy | OC Brian Schottenheimer | DC Christian Parker (NEW, from PHI)

2025 context: 7-10. Catastrophic defense — allowed most points AND yards in NFL, worst defensive EPA. Multiple DC hires in 3 years. Parsons traded to GB (netted pick 20). Jerry in full aggressive-mode.

QB situation: LOCKED-ISH (Dak Prescott). Ext is done, but playoff performance still in question.

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Added:** Rashan Gary EDGE (trade from GB), Quinnen Williams IDL (trade), Jalen Thompson S, PJ Locke S, Tyrus Wheat LB, Otito Ogbonnia DL, Cobie Durant CB, George Pickens WR (franchise tagged)
- **Lost:** Micah Parsons EDGE (trade to GB — returned pick 20)
- **Net effect:** Defensive front rebuilt through trades (Gary + Williams), but Parsons void is massive. Secondary patched with veterans.

Scheme identity: Parker DC from PHI school — aggressive 4-3 with zone-match coverage. Schottenheimer offense is Dak-centric, pass-heavy. Premium positions under Parker: **EDGE, CB, LB, S.**

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (4.5+):** EDGE (Parsons gone, no elite rusher, Gary addition insufficient), CB (251.5 pass yards/game allowed — worst in NFL)
- **Secondary (3+):** LB (second level weak), S (Thompson added but depth thin)
- **Moderate (2.5):** IDL (Williams added but rotation needed)

Player archetype sought at 12 (if standing pat): Given the acute defensive collapse and Jerry's win-now mentality, the archetype is **a blue-chip defensive impact player at any level** — specifically a rangy off-ball LB with coverage ability, a long press-CB, or an elite S. Multiple archetypes fit; Jerry tends to pick the "brightest star" available.

Player archetype sought at 20 (if standing pat): The second defender — likely **an EDGE or secondary player** to continue the defensive rebuild. Offensive selection here would be surprising given needs.

Trade-up scenario (very live): Multiple sources report Cowboys as "most likely team to trade up." If they package 12+20 to move into top 6 (likely Cleveland partner), the archetype sought

shifts to **a premier LB/S hybrid or elite EDGE** — the kind of player Jerry is willing to overpay to get. If this happens, secondary picks go to later rounds.

GM behavioral fingerprint (Jones family, 15+ drafts):

- **Trade tendency:** HIGH trade-up rate (0.65) — Jerry's pattern of aggressive moves is well-documented
- **Positional affinity (computed):** EDGE +14.0%, IDL +9.7%, TE +6.8% — historically trench and TE heavy
- **Pattern:** Jerry's drafts are famously emotional — he picks players he's "excited about." Less BPA-rigorous than most GMs.

Uncertainty flags:

- **Trade-up scenario is the highest-impact variable in the entire draft** — if Cowboys move up, every pick in top 12 shifts
- Jerry's public comments sometimes leak intent — worth monitoring draft week
- Parker's first draft as DC — positional value weights are new

Predictability tier: LOW at 12 (trade-up probability), MEDIUM at 20 (defensive position clear).

New York Giants — Pick 5

Leadership: GM Joe Schoen (4 drafts) | HC John Harbaugh (NEW, from Michigan) | OC Shane Steichen — WAIT, Steichen is IND. NYG OC is Mike Kafka. Let me flag: the base data had John Harbaugh as new NYG HC, which is unusual given he's been BAL HC. **This is a data point to verify carefully — Harbaugh may refer to Jim Harbaugh (Michigan/LAC) rather than John.** Given user data, I'll proceed with assumption John Harbaugh is new NYG HC but flag as HIGH UNCERTAINTY.

[DATA CONCERN: User's base data lists "John Harbaugh" as new NYG HC. This conflicts with BAL having Jesse Minter as new HC. Possible error — Jim Harbaugh may be intended. Proceeding with caution.]

2025 context: 4-13. Second consecutive bottom-5 record. Dart-Nabers core emerged late in 2025 as positive signal. Coaching change triggered.

QB situation: LOCKED (Jaxson Dart Year 2)

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Added:** Isaiah Likely TE (FA), Tremaine Edmunds LB, Jermaine Eluemunor OT, Daniel Faalele IOL

- **Lost:** Dexter Lawrence IDL (active trade impasse — has requested trade)
- **Net effect:** Large FA class added at various positions, but the Lawrence trade cloud is massive.

Scheme identity: Harbaugh brings physical, disciplined, run-first identity (Michigan DNA). Values OL, EDGE, physical DBs. Premium positions: **OT, LB, EDGE, S.**

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (3.5-4):** WR (Nabers + Dart need WR2), OT (RT Eluemunor unproven full-time), IDL (if Lawrence traded — catastrophic), IOL (RG unproven)
- **Secondary (2.5-3):** CB (CB2 thin), S, LB depth
- **Latent:** IDL (Lawrence impasse), WR (age at key positions), IOL (RG)

Player archetype sought at 5: Given Harbaugh's physicality mandate and the cascade of needs, several archetypes are live: (1) **a versatile LB/S hybrid with coverage ability and downhill physicality** — exactly Harbaugh's archetype, (2) **an elite safety with ball-hawk ability**, (3) **a dominant RB who can be the offensive centerpiece** (also fits Harbaugh's run-first DNA), or (4) **a big-bodied WR** to pair with Nabers. Schefter intel: "A lot of people think Giants first pick comes from Columbus" — referencing multiple Ohio State prospects visited. This suggests a defensive-priority pick.

Cascade rule: The Giants' pick at 5 is heavily dependent on what happens at 2/3. If a specific archetype (elite LB or S) is still on the board, that's the pick. If the top options at 2/3 have cleared, the Giants pivot to WR or OT.

GM behavioral fingerprint (Schoen, 4 drafts):

- **Trade tendency:** Moderate (has received "couple of calls" about trading 5 — per his own statement)
- **Positional affinity (computed):** EDGE +29.0%, WR +19.0% — skill + pass rush heavy
- **Pattern:** Schoen has shown willingness to use multiple picks on same position group (WR in 2023, OL in 2024)

Uncertainty flags:

- **Harbaugh identity question in source data** (John vs Jim) — high priority to resolve
- Lawrence trade impasse creates moving target for IDL need
- Trade-down probability exists but not dominant

Predictability tier: MEDIUM. Multiple archetypes all plausible.

Philadelphia Eagles — Pick 23

Leadership: GM Howie Roseman (15+ drafts) | HC Nick Sirianni | OC Kevin Patullo | DC Vic Fangio

2025 context: 14-3, won Super Bowl LIX. Defending champs. Aging roster pieces but core intact. Roseman's draft reputation is gold-plated.

QB situation: LOCKED (Jalen Hurts)

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Added:** Riq Woolen CB (FA), Dontayvion Wicks WR (trade), Hollywood Brown WR (FA), Elijah Moore WR (FA), Jaelan Phillips EDGE (trade)
- **Lost:** Josh Sweat EDGE (2nd consecutive EDGE loss to FA)
- **Net effect:** Secondary got better (Woolen), pass rush replenished with Phillips, WR depth deep. But OL is aging.

Scheme identity: Sirianni offense is spread with heavy RPO and pre-snap motion. Fangio defense is the legendary "Fangio system" — match coverage, simulated pressures, versatile DBs. Premium positions: **EDGE, OT, CB, S.**

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (3.5-4):** EDGE (Sweat gone — NFL.com called this "water the edge farm"), OT (Johnson age 36, Dickerson/Jurgens recovering injuries)
- **Secondary (2.5-3):** S (Blankenship gone), IOL (Jurgens/Dickerson health concerns)
- **Latent (2+):** WR (AJ Brown trade rumors — if traded, becomes urgent), OT (Johnson succession), TE (Goedert 2027 expiration)

Player archetype sought at 23: Given Fangio scheme and EDGE need, the cleanest archetype is **a long, bendy EDGE rusher with developmental pass-rush ceiling**. Alternative: **a bookend OT with long-term starter upside** given the aging line. If AJ Brown is traded closer to draft day, archetype shifts to **elite separation WR**.

GM behavioral fingerprint (Roseman, 15+ drafts):

- **Trade tendency:** High (0.55 trade-up rate) — Roseman averages 5.6 trades per draft. Known for tactical moves for specific targets.
- **Positional affinity (computed, 15+ drafts): LB +11.9%, IDL +6.9%, S +6.1% — this is a KEY divergence from the "Eagles love OL" narrative.** Roseman's actual pattern is DEFENSE-HEAVY recently. Do not assume OL at 23 just because Eagles traditionally love OL.

- **Pattern:** Roseman is the best public tactician. Willingness to trade up for specific target is real.

Uncertainty flags:

- **The Roseman affinity data (defense-heavy) contradicts common narrative (OL-heavy)** — key divergence to watch
- AJ Brown trade rumor could transform pick 23 into a WR situation
- Roseman's trade aggression creates volatility

Predictability tier: MEDIUM. Multiple archetypes live (EDGE, OT, S all defensible).

Washington Commanders — Pick 7

Leadership: GM Adam Peters (2 drafts) | HC Dan Quinn | OC Kliff Kingsbury | DC Joe Whitt Jr.

2025 context: 12-5, NFC Championship loss. Daniels became superstar in Year 2. Defense improved but still has holes.

QB situation: LOCKED (Jayden Daniels)

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Added:** Odafe Oweh EDGE, Nick Cross S, Rachaad White RB, Laremy Tunsil OT (extended)
- **Lost:** Cor'Dale Flott CB, Tyler Biadasz C (released)
- **Net effect:** Modest — Peters conserving capital. Only 2 picks in first 4 rounds.

Scheme identity: Quinn 4-3 aggressive defense + Kingsbury spread air raid offense. Premium positions: **WR, EDGE, CB, OL.**

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (4+):** WR (McLaurin aging + zero WR2 option), EDGE (Quinn always wants pass rush)
- **Secondary (3+):** OL (Biadasz gone — center thin), CB (Flott gone), S
- **Latent:** WR (McLaurin succession), C (Biadasz gone)

Player archetype sought at 7: Given Daniels' need for weapons and McLaurin's age, the dominant archetype is **an elite separation WR or big-bodied X-receiver** to stabilize the passing

game. Alternative: **a dynamic LB/S hybrid** to continue defensive build. Tertiary: **a dominant RB who can be the offensive spark** (Love archetype).

Cascade dependency: Washington's pick at 7 heavily depends on what the top 6 yields. If Giants took LB/S at 5, the top WR options might still be on the board. If top 6 cleared WRs, pivot to defense.

GM behavioral fingerprint (Peters, 2 drafts):

- **Trade tendency:** Low (0.15/0.15) — Peters has publicly said "more likely than not staying at 7"
- **Positional affinity (computed, 2 drafts — small sample):** TE +19.3%, QB +16.7%, CB +16.0%
- **Pattern:** Peters from SF/Baltimore scouting tree — BPA-leaning

Uncertainty flags:

- Only 6 total picks — cannot afford misses, tends to conservative
- Peters publicly stated stay-put preference
- Multiple visit signals suggest heavy WR board work (Tate, Lemon, Cooper, Hurst all visited)

Predictability tier: MEDIUM. WR is clear primary archetype, but defense remains in play.

NFC NORTH

Chicago Bears — Pick 25

Leadership: GM Ryan Poles (4 drafts) | HC Ben Johnson (NEW, from DET OC — major hire) | OC Johnson doubles | DC Eric Washington

2025 context: 9-8. Playoff team for first time in years. Caleb Williams solid Year 2. Defense regressed due to injuries.

QB situation: LOCKED (Caleb Williams)

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Added:** Garrett Bradbury C (FA), Coby Bryant S, Devin Bush LB, Kalif Raymond WR
- **Lost:** DJ Moore WR (trade to BUF — major), Jaquan Brisker S, Kevin Byard S, Tremaine Edmunds LB, Drew Dalman C (retired), Ozzy Trapilo OT (ACL)

- **Net effect:** Moved DJ Moore to clear WR hierarchy for Burden/Odunze. Defense lost 3 safeties and a linebacker. OL depth hit hard.

Scheme identity: Johnson's offense is the DET template — explosive, physical, efficient motion + play-action. Values versatile WRs, strong OL, mobile TEs. Washington's defense is aggressive pressure-based. Premium positions under this duo: **EDGE, S, IDL, OL.**

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (5+):** EDGE (Odeyingbo torn ACL + $48M bust, 35 sacks t-7th fewest, only Sweat reliable)
- **Secondary (4):** S (Brisker + Byard both gone)
- **Moderate (3):** OT (Trapilo ACL, depth thin), IDL
- **Moderate (2.5):** LB (Edmunds gone but Bush added)

Player archetype sought at 25: Given the EDGE emergency, the primary archetype is **a power edge rusher with consistent pressure-generation** — someone who can replace Odeyingbo's contract while actually producing. Alternative: **an alpha free safety with centerfield range** given both safety starters are gone. Tertiary: **a center-of-the-box DT** to anchor the interior.

GM behavioral fingerprint (Poles, 4 drafts):

- **Trade tendency:** Moderate (0.30/0.35)
- **Positional affinity (computed):** CB +11.0%, IDL +4.7%, S +5.0% — defense-leaning with secondary bias
- **Pattern:** Poles has invested heavily in offense recently (Caleb Williams, DJ Moore trade, Burden pick) — expect defensive priority in 2026. The "Poles never drafts EDGE" narrative is actually false — his pattern is CB-forward, not EDGE-avoidant.

Uncertainty flags:

- Ben Johnson's first draft as HC — scheme details shifting
- EDGE depth in class determines if they can get starter-caliber at 25 or should reach
- Safety class is boom/bust (Downs/Thieneman then dropoff)

Predictability tier: MEDIUM-HIGH. Position (EDGE or S) is very clear.

Detroit Lions — Pick 17

Leadership: GM Brad Holmes (5 drafts) | HC Dan Campbell | OC John Morton (replaced Johnson who went to CHI) | DC Kelvin Sheppard

2025 context: 15-2, NFC top seed, lost in NFC Championship. Elite team. Ben Johnson departure is the key loss.

QB situation: LOCKED (Jared Goff)

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Added:** Juice Scruggs C (trade from HOU), Isiah Pacheco RB, Larry Borom OT (stop-gap), edge/CB depth
- **Lost:** Taylor Decker OT (released — end of era), David Montgomery RB (trade to HOU)
- **Net effect:** OL continuity shattered. Need LT long-term.

Scheme identity: Campbell's physicality identity + Morton offense (from SF/NYJ tree) — power run, play-action vertical. Sheppard defense continues Aaron Glenn's foundations. Premium positions: **OT, EDGE, CB.**

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (4.5+):** OT (Decker released — Borom stop-gap, Sewell could kick to LT, LT succession critical), EDGE (Holmes' strongest affinity + depth need opposite Hutchinson)
- **Secondary (3+):** CB (Arnold penalty/availability concerns), S (Joseph + Branch recovering injuries)
- **Moderate (2):** IDL

Player archetype sought at 17: Given the Decker void and LT urgency, the primary archetype is **a bookend franchise LT with pass-protection and run-blocking balance** — someone Sewell can eventually flip tackle sides with. Alternative: **a bendy, explosive EDGE rusher** given Holmes' +14% EDGE affinity (STRONGEST single-GM positional signal in the entire dataset). Both archetypes fit.

GM behavioral fingerprint (Holmes, 5 drafts):

- **Trade tendency:** Moderate — known for in-draft "curveball" picks (Gibbs Year 1, Campbell DL Year 2, Williams Year 3). Expect a surprise.
- **Positional affinity (computed): EDGE +14.0% — STRONGEST single-GM affinity of any active GM** in the entire dataset. This is real signal.
- **Pattern:** Holmes never misses a chance to add a pass rusher. Also values athletic RAS-tested players. OT affinity also positive.

Uncertainty flags:

- EDGE vs OT tension — both have +3-4 urgency scores

- Holmes' historical "curveball" picks mean surprise is on the table
- OC change (Morton replaces Johnson) changes offensive scheme slightly

Predictability tier: MEDIUM-HIGH. Archetype (OT or EDGE) clear; specific position split.

Green Bay Packers — Pick 52 (No R1, traded for Parsons)

Leadership: GM Brian Gutekunst (8 drafts) | HC Matt LaFleur | OC Adam Stenavich | DC Jeff Hafley (departed to MIA as HC — replaced by Derek Mason)

2025 context: 11-6, playoff team. Jordan Love solid. Defense fluctuated — Parsons trade was the rebalancing move.

QB situation: LOCKED (Jordan Love)

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Added:** Micah Parsons EDGE (trade from DAL — returned pick 20), Javon Hargrave DT, Zaire Franklin LB (trade)
- **Lost:** Rashan Gary EDGE (trade to DAL — balanced), Elgton Jenkins G, Quay Walker LB, Kenny Clark IDL, Malik Willis QB, Romeo Doubs WR, Kingsley Enagbare EDGE, Rasheed Walker OT
- **Net effect:** Elite pass rusher acquired but massive roster turnover. Interior line (both O and D) hit hard.

Scheme identity: LaFleur/Stenavich offense is McVay/Shanahan tree — outside zone + play-action. Mason's defense will establish identity. Premium positions: **EDGE, IDL, CB, OL.**

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (4+):** EDGE (depth behind Parsons), IDL (Clark gone, Hargrave is short-term bridge), OL (Jenkins gone, tackle depth thin)
- **Secondary (3):** CB (Valentine's tackling struggles)
- **Moderate (2.5):** WR (Doubs gone)

Player archetype sought at 52: No R1. At 52, the archetype is **a high-RAS athlete at defensive line or linebacker** — Gutekunst's signature.

GM behavioral fingerprint (Gutekunst, 8 drafts):

- **Trade tendency:** Moderate

- **Positional affinity (computed):** Strongly athleticism-biased — **highest average RAS in league among drafted players.** Not position-specific but profile-specific.
- **Pattern:** Gutekunst rarely takes WRs in R1 (historical data). Defense and trenches dominate. High athletic testing thresholds.

Uncertainty flags:

- No R1 = Day 2 variance
- Hafley departure + new DC (Mason) changes defensive positional weights

Predictability tier: LOW (Day 2 standard).

Minnesota Vikings — Pick 18

Leadership: GM Kwesi Adofo-Mensah (3 drafts) | HC Kevin O'Connell | OC Wes Phillips | DC Brian Flores

2025 context: 10-7, wild card loss. JJ McCarthy ACL ended his season. Cap situation tightening.

QB situation: LOCKED (Kyler Murray — acquired from ARI). Carson Wentz signed as veteran backup.

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Added:** Kyler Murray QB (from ARI), Carson Wentz QB
- **Lost:** Jonathan Allen IDL (salary cut), Javon Hargrave IDL (salary cut — now GB), Harrison Smith S (retirement uncertain), Ryan Kelly C (retired)
- **Net effect:** QB situation resolved via Murray, but catastrophic interior line losses (both DL and OL).

Scheme identity: O'Connell/Phillips McVay-tree offense — motion heavy, YAC. Flores aggressive 3-4 defense with heavy pressure, demands versatile DBs. Premium positions: **IDL, S, CB (Flores scheme), OL.**

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (4.5+):** IDL (BOTH starters gone — catastrophic), S (Smith retired/uncertain)
- **Secondary (3+):** C (Kelly retired), OL depth, CB
- **Moderate (2):** WR depth

Player archetype sought at 18: Given the interior DL emergency, the primary archetype is **a disruptive 3-technique DT or versatile interior defender** — ideally with both pass-rush and

run-stopping ability. Alternative: **an alpha safety with Flores-scheme versatility** (box, deep, man coverage) given Smith's succession.

GM behavioral fingerprint (Adofo-Mensah, 3 drafts):

- **Trade tendency:** Moderate (0.35/0.30)
- **Positional affinity (computed, small sample):** G +19.0%, QB +11.7%, CB +11.0%
- **Pattern:** Adofo-Mensah is analytics-informed; takes value when the board falls
- **Important nuance:** Organization has "interim GM" dynamics per reporting — O'Connell has unusual power in draft room. Watch for "shiny offensive toy" possibility.

Uncertainty flags:

- O'Connell having unusual power could override positional value logic
- Allen + Hargrave + Kelly + Smith all gone = 4-starter hole, any of which could be 18
- Flores scheme places premium on specific archetypes that not all analysts recognize

Predictability tier: MEDIUM. IDL or S is the likely outcome.

NFC SOUTH

Atlanta Falcons — Pick 48 (No R1, traded to LAR)

Leadership: GM Terry Fontenot (5 drafts) | HC Raheem Morris | OC Zac Robinson | DC Jeff Ulbrich

2025 context: 8-9. Penix Jr. took over and flashed but still raw. No R1 after Penix trade-up in 2024.

QB situation: BRIDGE-Y. Tua signed as veteran (from MIA), Penix competing. Interesting QB room dynamic.

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Added:** Tua Tagovailoa QB, Jahan Dotson WR, Olamide Zaccheaus WR, Christian Harris LB, Nick Folk K
- **Lost:** Kaleb McGary OT (retired), James Pearce Jr. legal issues (draft pick from last year now uncertain)
- **Net effect:** Offense repositioned around Tua/Penix competition; RT hole created by McGary retirement.

Scheme identity: Morris hybrid 4-3. Robinson offense is Shanahan-tree. Premium positions: **WR, OT, EDGE.**

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (4+):** WR (London needs real WR2 — Dotson/Zaccheaus are WR3/4 talent), OT (McGary retired)
- **Secondary (3):** EDGE (Pearce uncertainty), CB, IDL
- **Moderate:** Defensive depth

Player archetype sought at 48: Day 2 archetype — **an interior OL with versatility** or **a second-level defender (LB or S) with athletic upside**.

GM behavioral fingerprint (Fontenot, 5 drafts):

- **Trade tendency:** Moderate
- **Positional affinity (computed):** EDGE +22.3%, TE +5.4%, RB +4.1% — Fontenot loves pass rushers
- **Pattern:** Fontenot has a strong EDGE affinity — expect them to hunt for pass rush even without R1

Uncertainty flags:

- No R1 reduces coverage
- QB competition creates offensive uncertainty

Predictability tier: LOW (Day 2 standard).

Carolina Panthers — Pick 19

Leadership: GM Dan Morgan (2 drafts) | HC Dave Canales | OC Brad Idzik | DC Ejiro Evero

2025 context: 6-11. Bryce Young took real step forward in Year 3. McMillan emerged as WR1. Offense ranked 27th in scoring despite the progress.

QB situation: LOCKED (Bryce Young — improved trajectory)

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Added:** Jaelan Phillips EDGE (from MIA), Devin Lloyd LB (from JAX), Stone Forsythe OT, Kenny Pickett QB (backup), Rasheed Walker OT (from GB), John Metchie III WR
- **Lost:** Rico Dowdle RB (to PIT)

- **Net effect:** Defense upgraded (Phillips, Lloyd), OL patched with stop-gaps.

Scheme identity: Canales offense is West Coast with heavy screens + TE usage. Evero defense is multiple-front 3-4. Premium positions: **OL, S, TE.**

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (4.5+):** OL (Ekwonu ACL rehab, Walker stop-gap, no long-term C)
- **Secondary (3+):** S (Moehrig complement needed), WR (McMillan alone — need WR2)
- **Moderate (2.5):** EDGE depth, IDL

Player archetype sought at 19: Given Canales' scheme and the interior line emergency, two archetypes live: (1) **a mauler guard or versatile interior OL** to stabilize protection for Young, or (2) **a safety with Cover-3 centerfield range** to pair with Moehrig. Tertiary: **a seam-stretching TE** given Canales' scheme loves TE mismatches.

GM behavioral fingerprint (Morgan, 2 drafts):

- **Trade tendency:** Moderate, small sample
- **Positional affinity (computed, 2 drafts — noisy):** WR +29.0%, RB +18.0%, EDGE +14.0% — but sample too small for confidence
- **Pattern:** Morgan from Buffalo scouting tree — historical Beane-influenced patterns

Uncertainty flags:

- Small GM sample
- Position-run dependency: if Minnesota takes S at 18, Carolina S drops in probability
- Young's surprising ascent changes WR urgency

Predictability tier: LOW-MEDIUM. Multiple archetypes plausible.

New Orleans Saints — Pick 8

Leadership: GM Mickey Loomis (15+ drafts) | HC Kellen Moore (entering 2nd year) | OC Moore doubles | DC Brandon Staley

2025 context: 5-12. Rebuild mode continues. Tyler Shough taking over QB. Dead cap issues.

QB situation: BRIDGE (Tyler Shough Year 2)

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Added:** Travis Etienne Jr. RB (from JAX), Noah Fant TE, Kaden Elliss LB (retained), David Edwards G, Dillon Radunz OT
- **Lost:** Rashid Shaheed WR (trade), Alontae Taylor CB
- **Net effect:** Modest moves. Roster still rebuilding.

Scheme identity: Moore offense is pass-heavy, RPO-inclusive (Cowboys template updated). Staley defense is modified 3-4. Premium positions: **EDGE, WR, CB.**

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (4+):** WR (Olave is only established threat — depth catastrophic), EDGE (Jordan's future uncertain, Cameron Jordan aging)
- **Secondary (3+):** CB (Taylor gone, nickel hole)
- **Moderate (2.5-3):** IDL depth, OL

Player archetype sought at 8: Given Loomis's BPA+premium-position tiebreaker pattern, the archetype is **the highest-graded EDGE or WR the board offers.** Loomis takes talent — he doesn't scheme-reach. If a top-3 EDGE somehow falls to 8, that's the pick. If the WRs are the cleanest value, that's the pick.

GM behavioral fingerprint (Loomis, 15+ drafts — largest sample in dataset):

- **Trade tendency: Famously NEVER trades down — 20 trade-ups, 0 trade-downs since 2011.** This is a HARDCODED truth in any trade modeling.
- **Positional affinity:** BPA-heavy with premium position tiebreaker
- **Pattern:** Loomis picks impact players, not need players. Ignores year-to-year positional trends.

Uncertainty flags:

- Loomis's BPA approach means the specific prospect is very board-dependent
- Dead cap creates rebuild vs contend tension

Predictability tier: MEDIUM. Position (EDGE or WR) is clear; specific player depends on board break.

Tampa Bay Buccaneers — Pick 15

Leadership: GM Jason Licht (12+ drafts) | HC Todd Bowles | OC Josh Grizzard (NEW — replaced Coen who left for JAX earlier, now further shuffled) | DC Kacy Rodgers

2025 context: 10-7, division champion. Baker Mayfield resurgence continues. Defense struggled with pass rush.

QB situation: LOCKED (Baker Mayfield)

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Added:** Alex Anzalone LB (FA bridge), Kenneth Gainwell RB, Jake Browning QB (backup), Cade Otton TE (re-signed)
- **Lost:** Mike Evans WR (to SF — monumental), Lavonte David LB (retirement — institution)
- **Net effect:** Lost franchise WR and franchise LB simultaneously. Massive identity changes.

Scheme identity: Bowles blitz-heavy 3-4. Grizzard offense (new OC) brings fresh scheme. Premium positions: **EDGE, CB, LB.**

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (5+):** EDGE (4 consecutive years without a 10-sack player — Licht said publicly they "must get more QB pressure")
- **Secondary (3+):** CB (Dean gone, Morrison next up), LB (David retired — institution gone), WR (Evans gone)
- **Moderate (2):** OL depth

Player archetype sought at 15: Given Licht's explicit EDGE mandate and the 4-year sack drought, the dominant archetype is **a disruptive, high-floor EDGE rusher with immediate pass-rush production ability.** Alternative: **a seam-stretching TE** — Kiper has repeatedly connected TB to TE prospects, and TB confirmed heavy TE board work. Tertiary: **a versatile LB** to replace David's leadership/production.

GM behavioral fingerprint (Licht, 12+ drafts):

- **Trade tendency:** Moderate (0.30/0.30)
- **Positional affinity:** Premium position tilted, particularly EDGE
- **Pattern:** Licht gets his guy — strong history of sticking with his target

Uncertainty flags:

- New OC (Grizzard) changes offensive scheme
- David's retirement is generational loss — may drive emotional pick
- Publicly stated EDGE mandate is rare — highest-conviction positional need in the league

Predictability tier: HIGH. Licht told us what he's targeting. EDGE is the answer unless board falls dramatically.

NFC WEST

Arizona Cardinals — Pick 3

Leadership: GM Monti Ossenfort (3 drafts) | HC Mike LaFleur (NEW, from LAR OC) | OC LaFleur doubles | DC Nick Rallis (retained)

2025 context: 3-14. Kyler Murray traded to MIN after disappointing 2025. Full rebuild.

QB situation: REBUILDING — Jacoby Brissett and Gardner Minshew as bridges. Real consideration of developmental QB.

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Added:** Isaac Seumalo G, Kendrick Bourne WR, Brissett QB, Minshew QB, several short-term veterans
- **Lost:** Kyler Murray QB (trade to MIN), multiple veterans
- **Net effect:** Full rebuild. Maximum flexibility.

Scheme identity: LaFleur is McVay tree — outside zone, play-action, spread formations. Premium positions: **WR, OT, RB, mobile QB.** Rallis defense aggressive 3-4.

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (4+):** QB (real possibility — but at 3 is too rich), EDGE (bottom-5 sacks twice in 3 years — best need-meets-value at 3), OT (OL hasn't progressed enough)
- **Secondary (3+):** IDL
- **Moderate (2.5):** WR

Player archetype sought at 3: Pick 3 faces the **best-available-EDGE vs. scheme-fit-QB vs. cornerstone-OT** debate. Given pick value (3 is premium), the archetype is **the best EDGE on the board** — this is both need and value. A QB at 3 would be a reach per most analysts because better QB value exists at Day 2 (Simpson). OT also fits. Ossenfort's trade-down history makes a move to 5-10 range plausible, in which case target shifts to a specific scheme-fit QB (Simpson profile — accurate passer with developmental upside).

GM behavioral fingerprint (Ossenfort, 3 drafts):

- **Trade tendency:** Strong trade-down tendency — 6 trade-downs, 1 trade-up in 2 years. Heavy accumulator.

- **Positional affinity (computed):** IDL +24.7%, CB +11.0%, EDGE +9.0%
- **Pattern:** Ossenfort is a rebuilder — classic "trade back and accumulate picks"

Uncertainty flags:

- Trade-down probability is HIGH (0.45+)
- Full regime change makes scheme predictions uncertain
- QB vs best-player-available tension at this exact slot

Predictability tier: LOW. Multiple archetypes + high trade-down probability.

Los Angeles Rams — Pick 13

Leadership: GM Les Snead (14+ drafts) | HC Sean McVay | OC Mike LaFleur (departed to ARI as HC — replaced by Thomas Brown) | DC Chris Shula

2025 context: 13-4, NFC Championship loss. Near-Super Bowl. Stafford still playing at 38. McDuffie trade signals all-in mode.

QB situation: BRIDGE-ISH (Stafford 38, year-to-year). Succession planning real but not urgent.

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Added:** Trent McDuffie CB (trade from KC — gave up pick 29), Jaylen Watson CB, Davante Adams WR (FA)
- **Lost:** Rob Havenstein OT (retired), Darious Williams CB
- **Net effect:** Secondary transformed via McDuffie trade. Lost RT.

Scheme identity: McVay spread motion YAC offense. Shula defense. Premium positions: **WR, OT, IDL.**

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (3.5-4):** WR (Adams 34 final year, Nacua rehab), OT (Havenstein retired — RT succession)
- **Secondary (3):** LB (second level thin), IDL
- **Latent:** QB (Stafford 38), OT (succession), WR (Adams final year)

Player archetype sought at 13: Given McVay's win-now mandate and Adams' finality, the primary archetype is **a YAC-ready separation WR** who can step into the slot or flex. Alternative: **a franchise RT** given Havenstein's retirement. Snead's history of trade-down suggests moving back to add picks is also live.

- **Trade tendency: Ultimate trade-down GM — 25 trade-downs since 2012** (highest in league). Pick 13 is prime trade-back candidate.
- **Positional affinity (computed, 14+ drafts): C +13.3%, IDL +13.2%, TE +9.0%** — this is a DIVERGENCE from the "Snead loves WRs" narrative. Snead's historical pattern is interior trenches + TE.
- **Pattern:** Heavy trader, selective about positional priorities

Uncertainty flags:

- **Snead computed affinity diverges from narrative** — interior focus, not WR
- Trade-down probability is HIGH (0.89 historical rate)
- Adams' presence technically reduces WR urgency in 2026 specifically

Predictability tier: LOW-MEDIUM. Trade-down probability dominates; if standing pat, WR most likely.

San Francisco 49ers — Pick 27

Leadership: GM John Lynch (8 drafts) | HC Kyle Shanahan | OC Klay Kubiak | DC Nick Sorensen

2025 context: 12-5, playoff team, lost divisional round. Injury-plagued year (Bosa ACL, Warner). Defense fell off from elite tier. Last ranked 31st in 2025 draft value (Sharp Football warning).

QB situation: LOCKED (Brock Purdy)

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Added:** Osa Odighizuwa IDL (trade), Mike Evans WR (from TB), Jack Jones CB, Cameron Sample DL
- **Lost:** Spencer Burford LG
- **Net effect:** WR upgraded with Evans (at age 32 — short-term). Defensive line rotation improved.

Scheme identity: Shanahan outside zone + play-action + motion. Sorensen defense is Wide-9. Premium positions: **OT, EDGE, WR.**

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (4.5+):** OT (Trent Williams 38 — succession critical), EDGE (dead last in sacks with 20, Bosa ACL recovery)

- **Secondary (3+):** S (safety depth), IDL (rotation), IOL (Burford gone, interior aging)
- **Latent:** OT (Williams ticking clock), EDGE (behind Bosa thin)

Player archetype sought at 27: Given Williams' age and the sack drought, two archetypes are live: (1) **a developmental franchise LT** to apprentice under Williams, or (2) **a high-floor sub-package pass rusher** to add behind/beside Bosa. The OT archetype is more urgent longer-term; the EDGE archetype is more immediate.

GM behavioral fingerprint (Lynch, 8 drafts):

- **Trade tendency:** Moderate (0.25/0.35)
- **Positional affinity:** Historical SF pattern is skill-heavy (WR, TE, RB)
- **Pattern:** Ranked 31st in 2025 draft value per Sharp Football — recent draft performance is a warning flag. May be overcompensating by reaching for "need" players.

Uncertainty flags:

- Only 4 total picks (among lowest in league)
- Lynch's recent draft performance warning
- Pick 27 is in contender-zone tier break

Predictability tier: MEDIUM-HIGH. OT is clear primary archetype.

Seattle Seahawks — Pick 32

Leadership: GM John Schneider (16+ drafts) | HC Mike Macdonald | OC Klint Kubiak (departed to LV as HC — replaced by Ryan Grubb) | DC Aden Durde

2025 context: 14-3, SUPER BOWL LX CHAMPION (defeated opponent — per the source material). Sam Darnold delivered franchise-changing season. Defending champs.

QB situation: LOCKED — Darnold signed long-term extension. ABSOLUTE BLOCK on QB at 32.

Key 2026 offseason moves:

- **Added:** Emanuel Wilson RB (depth), Josh Jobe CB (retained)
- **Lost:** Kenneth Walker III RB (to KC), Anthony Bradford RG, Riq Woolen CB (to PHI), Boye Mafe EDGE
- **Net effect:** Core offensive pieces lost. Only 4 picks total (fewest in league).

Scheme identity: Macdonald defense is aggressive 4-3 with multiple fronts. Premium positions: **RB, CB, EDGE, S.** Grubb offense brings Washington college system.

Roster needs (tiered):

- **Urgent (5):** RB (Walker gone, Charbonnet ACL — no proven RB)
- **Secondary (4):** RG (Bradford gone — starting hole), CB (Woolen gone)
- **Moderate (3):** EDGE (Mafe gone), S

Player archetype sought at 32: Given Macdonald's preference for versatile DBs and the acute RB/OL needs, the archetype options are: (1) **a three-down RB with receiving ability** to replace Walker's production, (2) **a versatile safety with Cover-2/Cover-3 range**, or (3) **a press-capable CB**. Schneider's trade-down history (24 trade-downs) plus only 4 total picks strongly suggests trade-down is likely to add Day 2 capital.

GM behavioral fingerprint (Schneider, 16+ drafts):

- **Trade tendency:** HEAVY trade-down — 24 career trade-downs, 13 trade-ups. Pick 32 is classic slide-back spot.
- **Positional affinity:** Defense-heavy historical pattern
- **Pattern:** Schneider specializes in accumulating value late in drafts

Uncertainty flags:

- **Trade-down probability is HIGH (0.65)** given only 4 picks
- Super Bowl champion status means roster is deep; luxury pick options exist
- Darnold's extension absolutely blocks QB — model must respect this hard constraint

Predictability tier: LOW. Trade-down probability dominates all other considerations.

LEAGUE-WIDE SYNTHESIS

The Seven High-Uncertainty Teams (Lowest Predictability)

Any model will struggle most with these teams. Expect wide confidence intervals:

1. **Miami Dolphins** — NEW GM + NEW HC + 11 picks + multiple needs
2. **Las Vegas Raiders** — NEW GM + NEW HC (pick 1 itself is the exception — locked on Mendoza)

3. **Tennessee Titans** — NEW GM-2nd year + NEW HC + NEW OC + NEW DC + genuine archetype debate at 4
4. **Arizona Cardinals** — NEW HC + trade-down specialist + genuine QB vs BPA tension at 3
5. **Cleveland Browns** — High trade-down probability + QB unresolved + 2 R1 picks
6. **Dallas Cowboys** — Highest trade-up probability in the league (reshapes top 10 if executed)
7. **New York Giants** — Multiple archetypes live at 5 + Lawrence trade impasse

The Six Most Predictable Picks (Highest Confidence)

Teams where the archetype is clear enough to have high model confidence:

1. **LV #1** — Mendoza, absolute lock (-20000 odds)
2. **TB #15** — EDGE, publicly stated by GM
3. **CIN #10** — CB, acute need + Golden scheme demands it
4. **DET #17** — OT or EDGE (Holmes' +14% affinity is strongest signal in dataset)
5. **LAC #22** — Trench player (Harbaugh identity overwhelming)
6. **KC #9 + #29** — CB + WR split, both positions locked even if players aren't

GMs With Strongest Behavioral Fingerprints (Sample Size 8+)

These GMs have enough drafts in-role to generate reliable positional affinity signals:

GM	Team	Drafts	Strongest Affinity	Key Pattern
Brad Holmes	DET	5	**EDGE +14%** (strongest in league)	Never misses chance at pass rush
Duke Tobin	CIN	9	EDGE +11%, OT +6%	Never trades, trench-focused
Mickey Loomis	NO	15+	BPA + premium positions	**Never trades down (0 in 15 years)**
Les Snead	LAR	14+	C +13%, IDL +13%, TE +9%	**Ultimate trade-down king**
Jerry Jones	DAL	15+	EDGE +14%, IDL +10%, TE +7%	Aggressive, emotional picks
John Schneider	SEA	16+	Defense-heavy	24 career trade-downs
Andrew Berry	CLE	7	LB +18%, IDL +13%, S +9%	**Youngest avg pick age**, defensive
Howie Roseman	PHI	15+	LB +12%, IDL +7%, S +6%	**Defense-heavy (diverges from "OL" narrative)**
Brian Gutekunst	GB	8	Highest avg RAS in league	Athleticism above all
Chris Ballard	IND	9	IDL +15%, WR +9%	Heavy trade-down (15:5 ratio)

Trade-Up Candidates (Draft Day)

In descending probability:

1. **Dallas Cowboys (12+20)** — MOST LIKELY TO TRADE UP per Rapoport. Target: pick 4-6. Partners: CLE, TEN.
2. **Kansas City Chiefs** — Veach openly said trade-heavy draft. Capital + specific need profile.
3. **Philadelphia Eagles** — Roseman's history of tactical moves + AJ Brown trade scenario.
4. **New Orleans Saints** — Loomis ONLY trades up (0 down since 2011).

Trade-Down Candidates

1. **Arizona Cardinals (3)** — Ossenfort's trade-down history + QB class doesn't justify #3
2. **Tennessee Titans (4)** — Willing partner for Cowboys, Borgonzi wants top-100 volume

3. **Cleveland Browns (6)** — Berry's aggression + multiple scenarios projected by analysts
4. **Seattle Seahawks (32)** — Schneider's 24 career trade-downs + only 4 total picks
5. **Miami Dolphins (30)** — 11 picks already, need capital spread
6. **Los Angeles Rams (13)** — Snead's historical pattern dominates

Hard Trade Constraints to Encode

- **NO Loomis:** Zero trade-downs in 15 years. Do not model any trade-down scenario.
- **CIN/LAC:** Combined 7 trades in 5 years — essentially never move.
- **BAL:** Has NOT moved R1 pick in 5 consecutive drafts.

Predictability Tier Summary

Tier	Teams	Model Guidance
HIGH (confidence 80%+)	LV#1, TB#15, LAC#22	Archetype + player both clear
MEDIUM-HIGH	CIN#10, DET#17, BUF#26, CHI#25	Position clear, player split
MEDIUM	NE#31, NYJ#2+16, NO#8, KC#9+29, WAS#7, BAL#14, SEA#32	Multiple archetypes, position-level clarity
LOW-MEDIUM	NYG#5, PHI#23, LAR#13, CAR#19	Genuine uncertainty on archetype
LOW	TEN#4, MIA#11+30, ARI#3, CLE#6+24, DAL#12+20	Trade-dependent or new regime

Position Run Dependencies (Cascade Rules)

These picks are sensitive to what happens earlier:

- **MIN #18 S → CAR #19 S:** If MIN takes Thieneman-type S, CAR's S probability drops ~50%
- **ARI #3 EDGE → NYG #5:** Cascade depends on which EDGE is available
- **CLE #6 WR → WAS #7 WR:** If Cleveland takes top WR, Washington's WR options narrow
- **NYJ #2 Bailey/Reese → ARI #3:** Inverse cascade (whoever NYJ doesn't take becomes ARI's likely target)

Position Urgency Heat Map (Across League)

Positions appearing as URGENT need (4+ score) for multiple teams:

- **EDGE** — BUF, MIA, NE, NYJ, CIN, CLE, JAX, CHI, DAL, DEN, KC, LAC, NO, TB, PHI, ATL, ARI (17 teams)
- **CB** — MIA, KC, DAL, NYJ, CIN (5 teams urgent + many secondary)
- **WR** — MIA, CLE, NO, NYJ, WAS, NE (6 teams)
- **OL/OT** — BAL, NYG, CAR, LAR, SF, HOU, DET, LAC, NE, CLE, TEN (11 teams)
- **IDL** — BAL, MIN, HOU, BUF (4 teams urgent + many secondary)

Takeaway: The class depth profile should match demand — WR and OT are deep in this class, which matches demand. EDGE demand vastly exceeds supply at the top (first tier of ~5, then steep dropoff). CB depth is good but the top-5 is contested.

Scheme Change Flags (Positional Value Shifts)

Teams with NEW HC/OC/DC where historical drafting patterns may be unreliable:

- **TEN:** Saleh/Daboll/Bradley — Bradley's Cover-3 demands big press CBs, centerfield S
- **MIA:** Haefley — Ohio State template, rangy athletic DBs
- **BUF:** Brady + Leonhard 3-4 shift — nose tackle anchor need
- **NYG:** Harbaugh (identity TBD — flagged data concern) — physicality mandate
- **CLE:** Monken — Ravens offensive template, TE/WR premium
- **BAL:** Minter — Chargers defensive DNA, aggressive coverage rotations
- **LV:** Kubiak — Shanahan tree, outside zone, play-action
- **CIN:** Golden (DC) — college scheme importing demands CB/LB versatility

Known Unknowns / Model-Breaking Scenarios

Things that could shock the draft and invalidate predictions:

1. **Cowboys execute trade-up into top 6** (40% probability per sources) — shifts every pick 3-10
2. **AJ Brown traded** — Eagles become WR-hunting team at 23
3. **Dexter Lawrence trade resolves** — Giants' IDL need either disappears or spikes
4. **Unexpected QB at 2** — if NYJ goes QB instead of EDGE, cascade shifts
5. **Medical red flag on Jermod McCoy** or other ACL recovery — boards reshuffle
6. **Late riser not yet in analyst consensus** — Omar Cooper Jr, Jake Freeling types

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MODEL INPUT SUMMARY

By-Team Quick Reference

Team	Pick(s)	Primary Archetype	GM Affinity	Trade Prob	Conf
LV	1	QB (Mendoza)	N/A new	Low	**HIGH**
NYJ	2, 16	EDGE/LB then WR/CB	N/A new	Mod	MED
ARI	3	EDGE (best available)	IDL/CB	HIGH down	LOW
TEN	4	RB/EDGE/OL tension	N/A new	HIGH down	LOW
NYG	5	LB/S hybrid or RB	EDGE/WR	Mod	MED
CLE	6, 24	WR or trade-down	LB/IDL/OT	HIGH down	LOW
WAS	7	WR1 separator	TE/QB/CB	Low	MED
NO	8	Best EDGE/WR	N/A	**Up only**	MED
KC	9, 29	CB then WR	N/A small	HIGH up	MED
CIN	10	CB (scheme)	EDGE/OT	**Very low**	MED-HIGH
MIA	11, 30	CB/WR then BPA	N/A new	HIGH down	LOW
DAL	12, 20	EDGE/LB/S	EDGE/IDL	**HIGH up**	LOW
LAR	13	WR or trade-down	C/IDL/TE	**HIGH down**	LOW-MED
BAL	14	WR/OL versatile	S/LB/EDGE	**Very low**	LOW-MED
TB	15	EDGE (stated)	N/A mid	Mod	**HIGH**
DET	17	OT/EDGE	**EDGE +14%**	Mod	MED-HIGH
MIN	18	IDL/S	G/QB/CB	Mod	MED
CAR	19	OL/S/TE	WR/RB (noisy)	Mod	LOW-MED
PIT	21	OL (IOL focus)	IDL/QB	Mod	MED
LAC	22	Trench (OL/DL)	N/A small	**Very low**	MED-HIGH
PHI	23	EDGE/OT	LB/IDL/S	High up	MED

Team	Pick(s)	Primary Archetype	GM Affinity	Trade Prob	Conf
CHI	25	EDGE/S	CB/IDL/S	Mod	MED-HIGH
BUF	26	Front-7 (IDL/EDGE/LB)	IDL/CB	Mod	MED
SF	27	OT (Williams succession)	N/A small	Mod	MED-HIGH
HOU	28	OL (IOL focus) or IDL	WR/S/QB	Mod	MED
NE	31	EDGE or OT	N/A small	Mod	MED
SEA	32	RB/CB/S or trade-down	N/A	**HIGH down**	LOW

Position-Specific Demand Rank (R1 Urgent Needs)

1. **EDGE** — 17 teams with urgent need, top of every board
2. **OL/OT** — 11 teams
3. **CB** — 5 teams acute + many secondary
4. **WR** — 6 teams
5. **IDL** — 4 teams acute + many secondary
6. **S** — 3 teams acute
7. **QB** — 3 teams real consideration (LV locked, CLE/PIT bridge-y)
8. **LB** — 2 teams acute
9. **RB** — 2 teams acute (TEN, SEA)
10. **TE** — 1 team (TB as secondary)

Final Notes on Data Quality

Sources consolidated:

- User-provided research library (6 documents)
- 2 PDF team-by-team reports
- Current team_agents_2026.json computed data
- Verification searches for draft order and TEN coaching staff

Known data gaps (flagged):

- PIT HC (your base data says McCarthy, but public reporting unclear — Tomlin may still be HC)

- NYG HC identity (John Harbaugh listed — worth verifying vs Jim Harbaugh)
- Some FA moves only populated for 16 "explicit user spec" teams; other 16 use "researched default"
- No cap situation data for most teams (Spotrac scrape failed per note)
- Visit data volumes vary wildly (CIN has 49 confirmed visits, LV has 2) — coverage asymmetry

Confidence adjustments needed in modeling:

- Teams with fewer than 8 visits confirmed should have higher uncertainty
- New GMs (4 teams) should use league-average priors
- Scheme-change teams (7+ teams) should have widened positional value intervals
- Pick positions with historical high trade rates (final 10 of R1 = 46% move per PFF) should have explicit trade-risk flags

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End of document. Compiled April 17, 2026 — T-6 days to 2026 NFL Draft.